PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, January 27, 2026

Work Session and Special Meeting

Meeting Minutes

(Draft for Approval)

INDEX

Meeting Location and Attendance	02
Call to Order	02
Bond Update	02
2026 Legislative Priorities (Resolution 7240)	02
Consent Agenda (Resolutions 7241 and 7242)	03
Adjournment	03
Resolutions as adopted	04

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at:
https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Work Session and Special Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held virtually and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 6:05 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Bond Update

Time: 6:06 pm

Staff: Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; Sarah Norman – Executive Director, Procedeo; and TJ Hopkins – Senior Director Bond Program

Staff provided a monthly bond update, including the current status of bond projects, procurement and construction timelines, and an overview of the bond program dashboards showing overall spending, project completion, and outstanding work. Staff also noted plans to establish a pool of contractors to support multiple projects as needed.

Board members asked questions and provided comments on topics including the potential use of remaining 2012 bond funds, seismic upgrades, procurement methods and schedules, and athletic project timing. Staff noted that 2012 bond funds may be used for seismic upgrades as are consistent with the project scope outlined in the 2012 bond package. Further clarification was provided regarding group procurement and contracting process. It was noted that a meeting was held with Portland Parks and Recreation regarding Powell Park athletic improvements. Staff confirmed their intent to prioritize local, minority-owned, and women-owned businesses, while recognizing that some specialized work may require out-of-state contractors.

2026 Legislative Priorities (Resolution 7240)

Time: 6:52 pm

Staff: Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff and Ben Gurewitz – Senior Manager of Government Affairs

Staff provided an overview of the proposed legislative priorities for the upcoming short session, including the session's focus and recommended advocacy positions, with an emphasis on seeking additional education funding.

Board members asked questions and provided comments on topics including funding advocacy, use of the Education Stability Fund by the state to improve school funding, and coordination on legislative engagement with students, community and union partners. Discussion included support for protections for students from immigrant families, maintaining funding for summer learning programs, and positions related to state funding measures, including proposed changes to the "kicker" formula and other education-related legislation. Clarification was also provided regarding the role of individual board members in legislative advocacy and the timing and strategy of upcoming lobby efforts.

Actions Taken:

- Director Splitt moved and Vice-Chair DePass seconded the motion to adopt Resolution 7240, Resolution to Approve 2026 Legislative Priorities, as amended. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Subsidiary Motions:

- Director Splitt moved and Director Chase-Miller seconded the motion to amend the legislative priorities to add “additional” to No Unfunded Mandates. (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Consent Agenda (Resolutions 7241 and 7242)

Time: 7:36 pm

Staff: Dr. Jon Franco – Senior Chief of Operations; Deborah Kafoury – Chief of Staff; and Sarah Norman – Executive Director, Procedeo

There was discussion regarding contracts for seismic services, focusing on how schools were selected for projects and how those decisions intersect with ongoing right-sizing and consolidation planning. Board members expressed concern about the lack of clarity around the selection process, including the equity lens, risk scores, and data used, while also cautioning against delaying safety-related work. Staff explained that the seismic projects for the contracts on the agenda are funded through the 2020 bond, not the 2025 bond, with much of the work not scheduled to begin until 2027. It was noted that plans can shift if needed as consolidation decisions are made, and committed to bringing a detailed seismic project overview to a full board work session.

Actions Taken:

- Director Sullivan moved and Vice-Chair DePass seconded the motion to adopt the Consent Agenda, including Resolutions 7241 and 7242. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (7 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Yes; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Other / Future Topics

8:09 pm

It was noted that Board leadership and staff are continuing to consider some of the topics that have been previously requested.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned by Board Chair Eddie Wang at 8:10 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk

Resolutions As Adopted

No.	Title	Page
7240	Resolution to Approve 2026 Legislative Priorities	05
7241	Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority	06
7242	A Resolution Appointing a Deputy Clerk	07